



The triceps works against your biceps to straighten the arm.

The fingers and wrist are straightened by this long, thin muscle.

These muscles stabilize and help straighten your elbow.

The arm is bent at the elbow by your biceps.

HANDY TOOLS

Having two arms that can both reach out and fold inward, along with hands that can grasp objects, enables us to perform a number of powerful movements. These include throwing a ball, swimming, and playing tennis.

► THROWING A BALL

This sequence shows the different muscles you use when you throw a ball. First, the muscles pull your arm back (green), then others lift it up (brown). Once the ball is released, the muscles pull your arm down (red).



WOW!

Between them, your two hands contain more than a quarter of your body's 206 bones.

SHOULDER JOINT

The shoulder joint is one of the most mobile joints in your body. The round end of the upper arm bone fits into a curved pocket in the shoulder blade. Known as a ball-and-socket joint, this allows you to move your arm in all directions. Your shoulder joint is held together by tough straps called ligaments.

